THE EPISTLE OF PAUL TO THE

ROMANS

1 Paul, a servant of Christ Jesus, called to be an apostle, set
apart for the gospel of God, [2] which he promised before-
hand through his prophets in the holy Scriptures, [3] concern-
ing his Son, who was descended from David according to the
flesh [4] and was declared to be the Son of God in power accord-
ing to the Spirit of holiness by his resurrection from the dead,
Jesus Christ our Lord, [5] through whom we have received grace
and apostleship to bring about the obedience of faith for the
sake of his name among all the nations, [6] including you who
are called to belong to Jesus Christ,

[7] To all those in Rome who are loved by God and called to
be saints:

Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord
Jesus Christ.

[8] First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for all of you,
because your faith is proclaimed in all the world. [9] For God is
my witness, whom I serve with my spirit in the gospel of his
Son, that without ceasing I mention you [10] always in my prayers,
asking that somehow by God's will I may now at last succeed
in coming to you. [11] For I long to see you, that I may impart to
you some spiritual gift to strengthen you — [12] that is, that we
may be mutually encouraged by each other's faith, both yours
and mine. [13] I do not want you to be unaware, brothers, that I
have often intended to come to you (but thus far have been

prevented), in order that I may reap some harvest among you
as well as among the rest of the Gentiles. [14] I am under obliga-
tion both to Greeks and to barbarians, both to the wise and
to the foolish. [15] So I am eager to preach the gospel to you also
who are in Rome.

[16] For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power
of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first
and also to the Greek. [17] For in it the righteousness of God is
revealed from faith for faith, as it is written, "The righteous
shall live by faith."

[18] For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against
all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who by their
unrighteousness suppress the truth. [19] For what can be known
about God is plain to them, because God has shown it to
them. [20] For his invisible attributes, namely, his eternal power
and divine nature, have been clearly perceived, ever since the
creation of the world, in the things that have been made. So
they are without excuse. [21] For although they knew God, they
did not honor him as God or give thanks to him, but they
became futile in their thinking, and their foolish hearts were
darkened. [22] Claiming to be wise, they became fools, [23] and
exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images resem-
bling mortal man and birds and animals and creeping things.

[24] Therefore God gave them up in the lusts of their hearts
to impurity, to the dishonoring of their bodies among them-
selves, [25] because they exchanged the truth about God for a
lie and worshiped and served the creature rather than the
Creator, who is blessed forever! Amen.

[26] For this reason God gave them up to dishonorable pas-
sions. For their women exchanged natural relations for those
that are contrary to nature; [27] and the men likewise gave up nat-
ural relations with women and were consumed with passion
for one another, men committing shameless acts with men
and receiving in themselves the due penalty for their error.

[28] And since they did not see fit to acknowledge God, God
gave them up to a debased mind to do what ought not to
be done. [29] They were filled with all manner of unrighteous-
ness, evil, covetousness, malice. They are full of envy, murder,
strife, deceit, maliciousness. They are gossips, [30] slanderers,
haters of God, insolent, haughty, boastful, inventors of evil,
disobedient to parents, [31] foolish, faithless, heartless, ruthless.
[32] Though they know God's righteous decree that those who
practice such things deserve to die, they not only do them but
give approval to those who practice them.

2 Therefore you have no excuse, O man, every one of you
who judges. For in passing judgment on another you con-
demn yourself, because you, the judge, practice the very same
things. [2] We know that the judgment of God rightly falls on
those who practice such things. [3] Do you suppose, O man—
you who judge those who practice such things and yet do
them yourself—that you will escape the judgment of God?
[4] Or do you presume on the riches of his kindness and forbear-
ance and patience, not knowing that God's kindness is meant
to lead you to repentance? [5] But because of your hard and
impenitent heart you are storing up wrath for yourself on the
day of wrath when God's righteous judgment will be revealed.

[6]He will render to each one according to his works: [7]to
those who by patience in well-doing seek for glory and honor
and immortality, he will give eternal life; [8]but for those who
are self-seeking and do not obey the truth, but obey unrigh-
teousness, there will be wrath and fury. [9]There will be tribu-
lation and distress for every human being who does evil, the
Jew first and also the Greek, [10]but glory and honor and peace
for everyone who does good, the Jew first and also the Greek.
[11]For God shows no partiality.

[12]For all who have sinned without the law will also per-
ish without the law, and all who have sinned under the law
will be judged by the law. [13]For it is not the hearers of the
law who are righteous before God, but the doers of the law
who will be justified. [14]For when Gentiles, who do not have
the law, by nature do what the law requires, they are a law
to themselves, even though they do not have the law. [15]They
show that the work of the law is written on their hearts,
while their conscience also bears witness, and their conflict-
ing thoughts accuse or even excuse them [16]on that day when,
according to my gospel, God judges the secrets of men by
Christ Jesus.

[17]But if you call yourself a Jew and rely on the law and
boast in God [18]and know his will and approve what is excel-
lent, because you are instructed from the law; [19]and if you are
sure that you yourself are a guide to the blind, a light to those
who are in darkness, [20]an instructor of the foolish, a teacher
of children, having in the law the embodiment of knowledge
and truth—[21]you then who teach others, do you not teach

yourself? While you preach against stealing, do you steal?
[22]You who say that one must not commit adultery, do you
commit adultery? You who abhor idols, do you rob temples?
[23]You who boast in the law dishonor God by breaking the
law. [24]For, as it is written, "The name of God is blasphemed
among the Gentiles because of you."

[25]For circumcision indeed is of value if you obey the law,
but if you break the law, your circumcision becomes uncir-
cumcision. [26]So, if a man who is uncircumcised keeps the pre-
cepts of the law, will not his uncircumcision be regarded as
circumcision? [27]Then he who is physically uncircumcised but
keeps the law will condemn you who have the written code
and circumcision but break the law. [28]For no one is a Jew who
is merely one outwardly, nor is circumcision outward and
physical. [29]But a Jew is one inwardly, and circumcision is a
matter of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter. His praise
is not from man but from God.

3 Then what advantage has the Jew? Or what is the value of
circumcision? [2]Much in every way. To begin with, the Jews
were entrusted with the oracles of God. [3]What if some were
unfaithful? Does their faithlessness nullify the faithfulness of
God? [4]By no means! Let God be true though every one were a
liar, as it is written,

> "That you may be justified in your words,
> and prevail when you are judged."

[5]But if our unrighteousness serves to show the righteousness
of God, what shall we say? That God is unrighteous to inflict

wrath on us? (I speak in a human way.) [6]By no means! For then
how could God judge the world? [7]But if through my lie God's
truth abounds to his glory, why am I still being condemned
as a sinner? [8]And why not do evil that good may come?—as
some people slanderously charge us with saying. Their con-
demnation is just.

[9]What then? Are we Jews any better off? No, not at all. For
we have already charged that all, both Jews and Greeks, are
under sin, [10]as it is written:

"None is righteous, no, not one;
[11] no one understands;
no one seeks for God.
[12] All have turned aside; together they have become
worthless;
no one does good,
not even one."
[13] "Their throat is an open grave;
they use their tongues to deceive."
"The venom of asps is under their lips."
[14] "Their mouth is full of curses and bitterness."
[15] "Their feet are swift to shed blood;
[16] in their paths are ruin and misery,
[17] and the way of peace they have not known."
[18] "There is no fear of God before their eyes."

[19]Now we know that whatever the law says it speaks to those
who are under the law, so that every mouth may be stopped,
and the whole world may be held accountable to God. [20]For by

works of the law no human being will be justified in his sight,
since through the law comes knowledge of sin.

[21]But now the righteousness of God has been manifested
apart from the law, although the Law and the Prophets bear
witness to it—[22]the righteousness of God through faith in
Jesus Christ for all who believe. For there is no distinction:
[23]for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, [24]and
are justified by his grace as a gift, through the redemption
that is in Christ Jesus, [25]whom God put forward as a propiti-
ation by his blood, to be received by faith. This was to show
God's righteousness, because in his divine forbearance he
had passed over former sins. [26]It was to show his righteous-
ness at the present time, so that he might be just and the
justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus.

[27]Then what becomes of our boasting? It is excluded. By
what kind of law? By a law of works? No, but by the law of
faith. [28]For we hold that one is justified by faith apart from
works of the law. [29]Or is God the God of Jews only? Is he not
the God of Gentiles also? Yes, of Gentiles also, [30]since God is
one—who will justify the circumcised by faith and the uncir-
cumcised through faith. [31]Do we then overthrow the law by
this faith? By no means! On the contrary, we uphold the law.

4 What then shall we say was gained by Abraham, our fore-
father according to the flesh? [2]For if Abraham was justified by
works, he has something to boast about, but not before God.
[3]For what does the Scripture say? "Abraham believed God, and
it was counted to him as righteousness." [4]Now to the one who
works, his wages are not counted as a gift but as his due. [5]And

to the one who does not work but believes in him who justi-
fies the ungodly, his faith is counted as righteousness, [6]just
as David also speaks of the blessing of the one to whom God
counts righteousness apart from works:

[7] "Blessed are those whose lawless deeds are forgiven,
and whose sins are covered;
[8] blessed is the man against whom the Lord will not
count his sin."

[9]Is this blessing then only for the circumcised, or also
for the uncircumcised? For we say that faith was counted
to Abraham as righteousness. [10]How then was it counted
to him? Was it before or after he had been circumcised? It
was not after, but before he was circumcised. [11]He received
the sign of circumcision as a seal of the righteousness that
he had by faith while he was still uncircumcised. The pur-
pose was to make him the father of all who believe without
being circumcised, so that righteousness would be counted
to them as well, [12]and to make him the father of the circum-
cised who are not merely circumcised but who also walk in
the footsteps of the faith that our father Abraham had before
he was circumcised.

[13]For the promise to Abraham and his offspring that he
would be heir of the world did not come through the law but
through the righteousness of faith. [14]For if it is the adherents
of the law who are to be the heirs, faith is null and the promise
is void. [15]For the law brings wrath, but where there is no law
there is no transgression.

[16]That is why it depends on faith, in order that the promise
may rest on grace and be guaranteed to all his offspring—not
only to the adherent of the law but also to the one who shares
the faith of Abraham, who is the father of us all, [17]as it is writ-
ten, "I have made you the father of many nations"—in the
presence of the God in whom he believed, who gives life to
the dead and calls into existence the things that do not exist.
[18]In hope he believed against hope, that he should become the
father of many nations, as he had been told, "So shall your off-
spring be." [19]He did not weaken in faith when he considered
his own body, which was as good as dead (since he was about
a hundred years old), or when he considered the barrenness
of Sarah's womb. [20]No unbelief made him waver concerning
the promise of God, but he grew strong in his faith as he gave
glory to God, [21]fully convinced that God was able to do what
he had promised. [22]That is why his faith was "counted to him
as righteousness." [23]But the words "it was counted to him"
were not written for his sake alone, [24]but for ours also. It will
be counted to us who believe in him who raised from the dead
Jesus our Lord, [25]who was delivered up for our trespasses and
raised for our justification.

5 Therefore, since we have been justified by faith, we have
peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ. [2]Through him
we have also obtained access by faith into this grace in which
we stand, and we rejoice in hope of the glory of God. [3]Not only
that, but we rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering
produces endurance, [4]and endurance produces character, and
character produces hope, [5]and hope does not put us to shame,

because God's love has been poured into our hearts through
the Holy Spirit who has been given to us.

[6]For while we were still weak, at the right time Christ died
for the ungodly. [7]For one will scarcely die for a righteous per-
son — though perhaps for a good person one would dare even
to die — [8]but God shows his love for us in that while we were
still sinners, Christ died for us. [9]Since, therefore, we have now
been justified by his blood, much more shall we be saved by
him from the wrath of God. [10]For if while we were enemies we
were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more,
now that we are reconciled, shall we be saved by his life. [11]More
than that, we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus
Christ, through whom we have now received reconciliation.

[12]Therefore, just as sin came into the world through one
man, and death through sin, and so death spread to all men
because all sinned — [13]for sin indeed was in the world before
the law was given, but sin is not counted where there is no
law. [14]Yet death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over those
whose sinning was not like the transgression of Adam, who
was a type of the one who was to come.

[15]But the free gift is not like the trespass. For if many died
through one man's trespass, much more have the grace of
God and the free gift by the grace of that one man Jesus Christ
abounded for many. [16]And the free gift is not like the result
of that one man's sin. For the judgment following one tres-
pass brought condemnation, but the free gift following many
trespasses brought justification. [17]For if, because of one man's
trespass, death reigned through that one man, much more will

those who receive the abundance of grace and the free gift of
righteousness reign in life through the one man Jesus Christ.

[18]Therefore, as one trespass led to condemnation for all
men, so one act of righteousness leads to justification and life
for all men. [19]For as by the one man's disobedience the many
were made sinners, so by the one man's obedience the many
will be made righteous. [20]Now the law came in to increase
the trespass, but where sin increased, grace abounded all the
more, [21]so that, as sin reigned in death, grace also might reign
through righteousness leading to eternal life through Jesus
Christ our Lord.

6 What shall we say then? Are we to continue in sin that
grace may abound? [2]By no means! How can we who died to
sin still live in it? [3]Do you not know that all of us who have
been baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death?
[4]We were buried therefore with him by baptism into death, in
order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory
of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life.

[5]For if we have been united with him in a death like his, we
shall certainly be united with him in a resurrection like his.
[6]We know that our old self was crucified with him in order
that the body of sin might be brought to nothing, so that we
would no longer be enslaved to sin. [7]For one who has died has
been set free from sin. [8]Now if we have died with Christ, we
believe that we will also live with him. [9]We know that Christ,
being raised from the dead, will never die again; death no
longer has dominion over him. [10]For the death he died he died
to sin, once for all, but the life he lives he lives to God. [11]So you

also must consider yourselves dead to sin and alive to God in
Christ Jesus.

[12] Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body, to make
you obey its passions. [13] Do not present your members to sin
as instruments for unrighteousness, but present yourselves to
God as those who have been brought from death to life, and
your members to God as instruments for righteousness. [14] For
sin will have no dominion over you, since you are not under
law but under grace.

[15] What then? Are we to sin because we are not under law
but under grace? By no means! [16] Do you not know that if you
present yourselves to anyone as obedient slaves, you are slaves
of the one whom you obey, either of sin, which leads to death,
or of obedience, which leads to righteousness? [17] But thanks
be to God, that you who were once slaves of sin have become
obedient from the heart to the standard of teaching to which
you were committed, [18] and, having been set free from sin, have
become slaves of righteousness. [19] I am speaking in human
terms, because of your natural limitations. For just as you
once presented your members as slaves to impurity and to
lawlessness leading to more lawlessness, so now present your
members as slaves to righteousness leading to sanctification.

[20] For when you were slaves of sin, you were free in regard
to righteousness. [21] But what fruit were you getting at that
time from the things of which you are now ashamed? For the
end of those things is death. [22] But now that you have been set
free from sin and have become slaves of God, the fruit you get
leads to sanctification and its end, eternal life. [23] For the wages

of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ
Jesus our Lord.

7 Or do you not know, brothers—for I am speaking to those
who know the law—that the law is binding on a person only
as long as he lives? [2] For a married woman is bound by law
to her husband while he lives, but if her husband dies she is
released from the law of marriage. [3] Accordingly, she will be
called an adulteress if she lives with another man while her
husband is alive. But if her husband dies, she is free from that
law, and if she marries another man she is not an adulteress.

[4] Likewise, my brothers, you also have died to the law
through the body of Christ, so that you may belong to
another, to him who has been raised from the dead, in order
that we may bear fruit for God. [5] For while we were living
in the flesh, our sinful passions, aroused by the law, were at
work in our members to bear fruit for death. [6] But now we are
released from the law, having died to that which held us cap-
tive, so that we serve in the new way of the Spirit and not in
the old way of the written code.

[7] What then shall we say? That the law is sin? By no means!
Yet if it had not been for the law, I would not have known sin.
For I would not have known what it is to covet if the law had
not said, "You shall not covet." [8] But sin, seizing an opportu-
nity through the commandment, produced in me all kinds of
covetousness. For apart from the law, sin lies dead. [9] I was once
alive apart from the law, but when the commandment came,
sin came alive and I died. [10] The very commandment that
promised life proved to be death to me. [11] For sin, seizing an

opportunity through the commandment, deceived me and
through it killed me. [12] So the law is holy, and the command-
ment is holy and righteous and good.

[13] Did that which is good, then, bring death to me? By no
means! It was sin, producing death in me through what is
good, in order that sin might be shown to be sin, and through
the commandment might become sinful beyond measure.
[14] For we know that the law is spiritual, but I am of the flesh,
sold under sin. [15] For I do not understand my own actions. For
I do not do what I want, but I do the very thing I hate. [16] Now
if I do what I do not want, I agree with the law, that it is good.
[17] So now it is no longer I who do it, but sin that dwells within
me. [18] For I know that nothing good dwells in me, that is, in my
flesh. For I have the desire to do what is right, but not the abil-
ity to carry it out. [19] For I do not do the good I want, but the evil I
do not want is what I keep on doing. [20] Now if I do what I do not
want, it is no longer I who do it, but sin that dwells within me.

[21] So I find it to be a law that when I want to do right, evil
lies close at hand. [22] For I delight in the law of God, in my inner
being, [23] but I see in my members another law waging war
against the law of my mind and making me captive to the law of
sin that dwells in my members. [24] Wretched man that I am! Who
will deliver me from this body of death? [25] Thanks be to God
through Jesus Christ our Lord! So then, I myself serve the law
of God with my mind, but with my flesh I serve the law of sin.

8 There is therefore now no condemnation for those who
are in Christ Jesus. [2] For the law of the Spirit of life has set you
free in Christ Jesus from the law of sin and death. [3] For God has

done what the law, weakened by the flesh, could not do. By
sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin,
he condemned sin in the flesh, [4] in order that the righteous
requirement of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not
according to the flesh but according to the Spirit. [5] For those
who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things
of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit set their
minds on the things of the Spirit. [6] For to set the mind on the
flesh is death, but to set the mind on the Spirit is life and
peace. [7] For the mind that is set on the flesh is hostile to God,
for it does not submit to God's law; indeed, it cannot. [8] Those
who are in the flesh cannot please God.

[9] You, however, are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if in
fact the Spirit of God dwells in you. Anyone who does not have
the Spirit of Christ does not belong to him. [10] But if Christ is
in you, although the body is dead because of sin, the Spirit is
life because of righteousness. [11] If the Spirit of him who raised
Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who raised Christ Jesus
from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through
his Spirit who dwells in you.

[12] So then, brothers, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live
according to the flesh. [13] For if you live according to the flesh
you will die, but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds
of the body, you will live. [14] For all who are led by the Spirit
of God are sons of God. [15] For you did not receive the spirit of
slavery to fall back into fear, but you have received the Spirit of
adoption as sons, by whom we cry, "Abba! Father!" [16] The Spirit
himself bears witness with our spirit that we are children of

God, [17] and if children, then heirs—heirs of God and fellow
heirs with Christ, provided we suffer with him in order that
we may also be glorified with him.

[18] For I consider that the sufferings of this present time are
not worth comparing with the glory that is to be revealed to
us. [19] For the creation waits with eager longing for the reveal-
ing of the sons of God. [20] For the creation was subjected to
futility, not willingly, but because of him who subjected it,
in hope [21] that the creation itself will be set free from its bond-
age to corruption and obtain the freedom of the glory of the
children of God. [22] For we know that the whole creation has
been groaning together in the pains of childbirth until now.
[23] And not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the
firstfruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for
adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies. [24] For in this
hope we were saved. Now hope that is seen is not hope. For
who hopes for what he sees? [25] But if we hope for what we do
not see, we wait for it with patience.

[26] Likewise the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do
not know what to pray for as we ought, but the Spirit him-
self intercedes for us with groanings too deep for words. [27] And
he who searches hearts knows what is the mind of the Spirit,
because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will
of God. [28] And we know that for those who love God all things
work together for good, for those who are called according to
his purpose. [29] For those whom he foreknew he also predes-
tined to be conformed to the image of his Son, in order that
he might be the firstborn among many brothers. [30] And those

whom he predestined he also called, and those whom he called
he also justified, and those whom he justified he also glorified.

[31] What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us,
who can be against us? [32] He who did not spare his own Son
but gave him up for us all, how will he not also with him gra-
ciously give us all things? [33] Who shall bring any charge against
God's elect? It is God who justifies. [34] Who is to condemn?
Christ Jesus is the one who died—more than that, who was
raised—who is at the right hand of God, who indeed is inter-
ceding for us. [35] Who shall separate us from the love of Christ?
Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or
nakedness, or danger, or sword? [36] As it is written,

> "For your sake we are being killed all the day long;
> we are regarded as sheep to be slaughtered."

[37] No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through
him who loved us. [38] For I am sure that neither death nor life,
nor angels nor rulers, nor things present nor things to come,
nor powers, [39] nor height nor depth, nor anything else in all
creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God in
Christ Jesus our Lord.

9 I am speaking the truth in Christ—I am not lying; my
conscience bears me witness in the Holy Spirit—[2] that I have
great sorrow and unceasing anguish in my heart. [3] For I could
wish that I myself were accursed and cut off from Christ for
the sake of my brothers, my kinsmen according to the flesh.
[4] They are Israelites, and to them belong the adoption, the
glory, the covenants, the giving of the law, the worship, and

the promises. [5]To them belong the patriarchs, and from their
race, according to the flesh, is the Christ, who is God over all,
blessed forever. Amen.

[6]But it is not as though the word of God has failed. For not
all who are descended from Israel belong to Israel, [7]and not all
are children of Abraham because they are his offspring, but
"Through Isaac shall your offspring be named." [8]This means
that it is not the children of the flesh who are the children of
God, but the children of the promise are counted as offspring.
[9]For this is what the promise said: "About this time next year I
will return, and Sarah shall have a son." [10]And not only so, but
also when Rebekah had conceived children by one man, our
forefather Isaac, [11]though they were not yet born and had done
nothing either good or bad—in order that God's purpose of
election might continue, not because of works but because
of him who calls—[12]she was told, "The older will serve the
younger." [13]As it is written, "Jacob I loved, but Esau I hated."

[14]What shall we say then? Is there injustice on God's part?
By no means! [15]For he says to Moses, "I will have mercy on
whom I have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I
have compassion." [16]So then it depends not on human will or
exertion, but on God, who has mercy. [17]For the Scripture says
to Pharaoh, "For this very purpose I have raised you up, that
I might show my power in you, and that my name might be
proclaimed in all the earth." [18]So then he has mercy on whom-
ever he wills, and he hardens whomever he wills.

[19]You will say to me then, "Why does he still find fault? For
who can resist his will?" [20]But who are you, O man, to answer

back to God? Will what is molded say to its molder, "Why have
you made me like this?" [21]Has the potter no right over the clay,
to make out of the same lump one vessel for honorable use
and another for dishonorable use? [22]What if God, desiring to
show his wrath and to make known his power, has endured
with much patience vessels of wrath prepared for destruction,
[23]in order to make known the riches of his glory for vessels of
mercy, which he has prepared beforehand for glory—[24]even
us whom he has called, not from the Jews only but also from
the Gentiles? [25]As indeed he says in Hosea,

"Those who were not my people I will call 'my
people,'
and her who was not beloved I will call
'beloved.'"
[26] "And in the very place where it was said to them,
'You are not my people,'
there they will be called 'sons of the living
God.'"

[27]And Isaiah cries out concerning Israel: "Though the
number of the sons of Israel be as the sand of the sea, only
a remnant of them will be saved, [28]for the Lord will carry out
his sentence upon the earth fully and without delay." [29]And as
Isaiah predicted,

"If the Lord of hosts had not left us offspring,
we would have been like Sodom
and become like Gomorrah."

[30]What shall we say, then? That Gentiles who did not pursue righteousness have attained it, that is, a righteousness that is by faith; [31]but that Israel who pursued a law that would lead to righteousness did not succeed in reaching that law. [32]Why? Because they did not pursue it by faith, but as if it were based on works. They have stumbled over the stumbling stone, [33]as it is written,

> "Behold, I am laying in Zion a stone of stumbling,
> and a rock of offense;
> and whoever believes in him will not be put to
> shame."

10 Brothers, my heart's desire and prayer to God for them is that they may be saved. [2]For I bear them witness that they have a zeal for God, but not according to knowledge. [3]For, being ignorant of the righteousness of God, and seeking to establish their own, they did not submit to God's righteousness. [4]For Christ is the end of the law for righteousness to everyone who believes.

[5]For Moses writes about the righteousness that is based on the law, that the person who does the commandments shall live by them. [6]But the righteousness based on faith says, "Do not say in your heart, 'Who will ascend into heaven?' " (that is, to bring Christ down) [7]"or 'Who will descend into the abyss?' " (that is, to bring Christ up from the dead). [8]But what does it say? "The word is near you, in your mouth and in your heart" (that is, the word of faith that we proclaim); [9]because, if you confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. [10]For with

the heart one believes and is justified, and with the mouth one confesses and is saved. [11]For the Scripture says, "Everyone who believes in him will not be put to shame." [12]For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek; for the same Lord is Lord of all, bestowing his riches on all who call on him. [13]For "everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved."

[14]How then will they call on him in whom they have not believed? And how are they to believe in him of whom they have never heard? And how are they to hear without someone preaching? [15]And how are they to preach unless they are sent? As it is written, "How beautiful are the feet of those who preach the good news!" [16]But they have not all obeyed the gospel. For Isaiah says, "Lord, who has believed what he has heard from us?" [17]So faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ.

[18]But I ask, have they not heard? Indeed they have, for

> "Their voice has gone out to all the earth,
> and their words to the ends of the world."

[19]But I ask, did Israel not understand? First Moses says,

> "I will make you jealous of those who are not a nation;
> with a foolish nation I will make you angry."

[20]Then Isaiah is so bold as to say,

> "I have been found by those who did not seek me;
> I have shown myself to those who did not ask
> for me."

[21]But of Israel he says, "All day long I have held out my hands
to a disobedient and contrary people."

11 I ask, then, has God rejected his people? By no means! For
I myself am an Israelite, a descendant of Abraham, a mem-
ber of the tribe of Benjamin. [2]God has not rejected his people
whom he foreknew. Do you not know what the Scripture says
of Elijah, how he appeals to God against Israel? [3]"Lord, they
have killed your prophets, they have demolished your altars,
and I alone am left, and they seek my life." [4]But what is God's
reply to him? "I have kept for myself seven thousand men
who have not bowed the knee to Baal." [5]So too at the present
time there is a remnant, chosen by grace. [6]But if it is by grace,
it is no longer on the basis of works; otherwise grace would no
longer be grace.

[7]What then? Israel failed to obtain what it was seeking.
The elect obtained it, but the rest were hardened, [8]as it is
written,

"God gave them a spirit of stupor,
eyes that would not see
and ears that would not hear,
down to this very day."

[9]And David says,

"Let their table become a snare and a trap,
a stumbling block and a retribution for them;
[10] let their eyes be darkened so that they cannot see,
and bend their backs forever."

[11]So I ask, did they stumble in order that they might fall?
By no means! Rather, through their trespass salvation has
come to the Gentiles, so as to make Israel jealous. [12]Now if
their trespass means riches for the world, and if their failure
means riches for the Gentiles, how much more will their full
inclusion mean!

[13]Now I am speaking to you Gentiles. Inasmuch then as
I am an apostle to the Gentiles, I magnify my ministry [14]in
order somehow to make my fellow Jews jealous, and thus save
some of them. [15]For if their rejection means the reconciliation
of the world, what will their acceptance mean but life from
the dead? [16]If the dough offered as firstfruits is holy, so is the
whole lump, and if the root is holy, so are the branches.

[17]But if some of the branches were broken off, and you,
although a wild olive shoot, were grafted in among the others
and now share in the nourishing root of the olive tree, [18]do not
be arrogant toward the branches. If you are, remember it is
not you who support the root, but the root that supports you.
[19]Then you will say, "Branches were broken off so that I might
be grafted in." [20]That is true. They were broken off because
of their unbelief, but you stand fast through faith. So do not
become proud, but fear. [21]For if God did not spare the natural
branches, neither will he spare you. [22]Note then the kindness
and the severity of God: severity toward those who have fallen,
but God's kindness to you, provided you continue in his kind-
ness. Otherwise you too will be cut off. [23]And even they, if they
do not continue in their unbelief, will be grafted in, for God
has the power to graft them in again. [24]For if you were cut from

what is by nature a wild olive tree, and grafted, contrary to
nature, into a cultivated olive tree, how much more will these,
the natural branches, be grafted back into their own olive tree.
[25] Lest you be wise in your own sight, I do not want you to
be unaware of this mystery, brothers: a partial hardening has
come upon Israel, until the fullness of the Gentiles has come
in. [26] And in this way all Israel will be saved, as it is written,

"The Deliverer will come from Zion,
he will banish ungodliness from Jacob";
27 "and this will be my covenant with them
when I take away their sins."

[28] As regards the gospel, they are enemies for your sake. But as
regards election, they are beloved for the sake of their fore-
fathers. [29] For the gifts and the calling of God are irrevocable.
[30] For just as you were at one time disobedient to God but now
have received mercy because of their disobedience, [31] so they
too have now been disobedient in order that by the mercy
shown to you they also may now receive mercy. [32] For God has
consigned all to disobedience, that he may have mercy on all.
[33] Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowl-
edge of God! How unsearchable are his judgments and how
inscrutable his ways!

34 "For who has known the mind of the Lord,
or who has been his counselor?"
35 "Or who has given a gift to him
that he might be repaid?"

[36] For from him and through him and to him are all things. To
him be glory forever. Amen.
12 I appeal to you therefore, brothers, by the mercies of God,
to present your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and accept-
able to God, which is your spiritual worship. [2] Do not be con-
formed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of
your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of
God, what is good and acceptable and perfect.
[3] For by the grace given to me I say to everyone among you
not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think, but
to think with sober judgment, each according to the measure
of faith that God has assigned. [4] For as in one body we have many
members, and the members do not all have the same function,
[5] so we, though many, are one body in Christ, and individually
members one of another. [6] Having gifts that differ according to
the grace given to us, let us use them: if prophecy, in propor-
tion to our faith; [7] if service, in our serving; the one who teaches,
in his teaching; [8] the one who exhorts, in his exhortation; the
one who contributes, in generosity; the one who leads, with
zeal; the one who does acts of mercy, with cheerfulness.
[9] Let love be genuine. Abhor what is evil; hold fast to what
is good. [10] Love one another with brotherly affection. Outdo
one another in showing honor. [11] Do not be slothful in zeal, be
fervent in spirit, serve the Lord. [12] Rejoice in hope, be patient in
tribulation, be constant in prayer. [13] Contribute to the needs of
the saints and seek to show hospitality.
[14] Bless those who persecute you; bless and do not curse
them. [15] Rejoice with those who rejoice, weep with those who

weep. [16]Live in harmony with one another. Do not be haughty,
but associate with the lowly. Never be wise in your own sight.
[17]Repay no one evil for evil, but give thought to do what is
honorable in the sight of all. [18]If possible, so far as it depends
on you, live peaceably with all. [19]Beloved, never avenge your-
selves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written,
"Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord." [20]To the con-
trary, "if your enemy is hungry, feed him; if he is thirsty, give
him something to drink; for by so doing you will heap burn-
ing coals on his head." [21]Do not be overcome by evil, but over-
come evil with good.

13 Let every person be subject to the governing authorities.
For there is no authority except from God, and those that exist
have been instituted by God. [2]Therefore whoever resists the
authorities resists what God has appointed, and those who
resist will incur judgment. [3]For rulers are not a terror to good
conduct, but to bad. Would you have no fear of the one who
is in authority? Then do what is good, and you will receive his
approval, [4]for he is God's servant for your good. But if you do
wrong, be afraid, for he does not bear the sword in vain. For he
is the servant of God, an avenger who carries out God's wrath
on the wrongdoer. [5]Therefore one must be in subjection, not
only to avoid God's wrath but also for the sake of conscience.
[6]For because of this you also pay taxes, for the authorities are
ministers of God, attending to this very thing. [7]Pay to all what
is owed to them: taxes to whom taxes are owed, revenue to
whom revenue is owed, respect to whom respect is owed,
honor to whom honor is owed.

[8]Owe no one anything, except to love each other, for the
one who loves another has fulfilled the law. [9]For the com-
mandments, "You shall not commit adultery, You shall not
murder, You shall not steal, You shall not covet," and any
other commandment, are summed up in this word: "You
shall love your neighbor as yourself." [10]Love does no wrong to
a neighbor; therefore love is the fulfilling of the law.

[11]Besides this you know the time, that the hour has come
for you to wake from sleep. For salvation is nearer to us now
than when we first believed. [12]The night is far gone; the day
is at hand. So then let us cast off the works of darkness and
put on the armor of light. [13]Let us walk properly as in the day-
time, not in orgies and drunkenness, not in sexual immoral-
ity and sensuality, not in quarreling and jealousy. [14]But put on
the Lord Jesus Christ, and make no provision for the flesh, to
gratify its desires.

14 As for the one who is weak in faith, welcome him, but not
to quarrel over opinions. [2]One person believes he may eat any-
thing, while the weak person eats only vegetables. [3]Let not the
one who eats despise the one who abstains, and let not the one
who abstains pass judgment on the one who eats, for God has
welcomed him. [4]Who are you to pass judgment on the servant
of another? It is before his own master that he stands or falls.
And he will be upheld, for the Lord is able to make him stand.

[5]One person esteems one day as better than another,
while another esteems all days alike. Each one should be fully
convinced in his own mind. [6]The one who observes the day,
observes it in honor of the Lord. The one who eats, eats in

honor of the Lord, since he gives thanks to God, while the one
who abstains, abstains in honor of the Lord and gives thanks
to God. [7]For none of us lives to himself, and none of us dies to
himself. [8]For if we live, we live to the Lord, and if we die, we
die to the Lord. So then, whether we live or whether we die,
we are the Lord's. [9]For to this end Christ died and lived again,
that he might be Lord both of the dead and of the living.

[10]Why do you pass judgment on your brother? Or you, why
do you despise your brother? For we will all stand before the
judgment seat of God; [11]for it is written,

> "As I live, says the Lord, every knee shall bow to me,
> and every tongue shall confess to God."

[12]So then each of us will give an account of himself to God.

[13]Therefore let us not pass judgment on one another any
longer, but rather decide never to put a stumbling block
or hindrance in the way of a brother. [14]I know and am per-
suaded in the Lord Jesus that nothing is unclean in itself, but
it is unclean for anyone who thinks it unclean. [15]For if your
brother is grieved by what you eat, you are no longer walk-
ing in love. By what you eat, do not destroy the one for whom
Christ died. [16]So do not let what you regard as good be spoken
of as evil. [17]For the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating
and drinking but of righteousness and peace and joy in the
Holy Spirit. [18]Whoever thus serves Christ is acceptable to God
and approved by men. [19]So then let us pursue what makes for
peace and for mutual upbuilding.

[20]Do not, for the sake of food, destroy the work of God.

Everything is indeed clean, but it is wrong for anyone to make
another stumble by what he eats. [21]It is good not to eat meat
or drink wine or do anything that causes your brother to
stumble. [22]The faith that you have, keep between yourself and
God. Blessed is the one who has no reason to pass judgment
on himself for what he approves. [23]But whoever has doubts is
condemned if he eats, because the eating is not from faith. For
whatever does not proceed from faith is sin.

15 We who are strong have an obligation to bear with the fail-
ings of the weak, and not to please ourselves. [2]Let each of us
please his neighbor for his good, to build him up. [3]For Christ
did not please himself, but as it is written, "The reproaches
of those who reproached you fell on me." [4]For whatever was
written in former days was written for our instruction, that
through endurance and through the encouragement of the
Scriptures we might have hope. [5]May the God of endurance
and encouragement grant you to live in such harmony with
one another, in accord with Christ Jesus, [6]that together you
may with one voice glorify the God and Father of our Lord
Jesus Christ. [7]Therefore welcome one another as Christ has
welcomed you, for the glory of God.

[8]For I tell you that Christ became a servant to the cir-
cumcised to show God's truthfulness, in order to confirm
the promises given to the patriarchs, [9]and in order that the
Gentiles might glorify God for his mercy. As it is written,

> "Therefore I will praise you among the Gentiles,
> and sing to your name."

[10]And again it is said,

"Rejoice, O Gentiles, with his people."

[11]And again,

"Praise the Lord, all you Gentiles,
and let all the peoples extol him."

[12]And again Isaiah says,

"The root of Jesse will come,
even he who arises to rule the Gentiles;
in him will the Gentiles hope."

[13]May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, so that by the power of the Holy Spirit you may abound in hope.

[14]I myself am satisfied about you, my brothers, that you yourselves are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge and able to instruct one another. [15]But on some points I have written to you very boldly by way of reminder, because of the grace given me by God [16]to be a minister of Christ Jesus to the Gentiles in the priestly service of the gospel of God, so that the offering of the Gentiles may be acceptable, sanctified by the Holy Spirit. [17]In Christ Jesus, then, I have reason to be proud of my work for God. [18]For I will not venture to speak of anything except what Christ has accomplished through me to bring the Gentiles to obedience—by word and deed, [19]by the power of signs and wonders, by the power of the Spirit

of God—so that from Jerusalem and all the way around to Illyricum I have fulfilled the ministry of the gospel of Christ; [20]and thus I make it my ambition to preach the gospel, not where Christ has already been named, lest I build on someone else's foundation, [21]but as it is written,

"Those who have never been told of him will see,
and those who have never heard will
understand."

[22]This is the reason why I have so often been hindered from coming to you. [23]But now, since I no longer have any room for work in these regions, and since I have longed for many years to come to you, [24]I hope to see you in passing as I go to Spain, and to be helped on my journey there by you, once I have enjoyed your company for a while. [25]At present, however, I am going to Jerusalem bringing aid to the saints. [26]For Macedonia and Achaia have been pleased to make some contribution for the poor among the saints at Jerusalem. [27]For they were pleased to do it, and indeed they owe it to them. For if the Gentiles have come to share in their spiritual blessings, they ought also to be of service to them in material blessings. [28]When therefore I have completed this and have delivered to them what has been collected, I will leave for Spain by way of you. [29]I know that when I come to you I will come in the fullness of the blessing of Christ.

[30]I appeal to you, brothers, by our Lord Jesus Christ and by the love of the Spirit, to strive together with me in your prayers to God on my behalf, [31]that I may be delivered from

the unbelievers in Judea, and that my service for Jerusalem
may be acceptable to the saints, [32]so that by God's will I may
come to you with joy and be refreshed in your company. [33]May
the God of peace be with you all. Amen.

16 I commend to you our sister Phoebe, a servant of the
church at Cenchreae, [2]that you may welcome her in the Lord
in a way worthy of the saints, and help her in whatever she
may need from you, for she has been a patron of many and of
myself as well.

[3]Greet Prisca and Aquila, my fellow workers in Christ
Jesus, [4]who risked their necks for my life, to whom not
only I give thanks but all the churches of the Gentiles give
thanks as well. [5]Greet also the church in their house. Greet
my beloved Epaenetus, who was the first convert to Christ
in Asia. [6]Greet Mary, who has worked hard for you. [7]Greet
Andronicus and Junia, my kinsmen and my fellow prison-
ers. They are well known to the apostles, and they were in
Christ before me. [8]Greet Ampliatus, my beloved in the Lord.
[9]Greet Urbanus, our fellow worker in Christ, and my beloved
Stachys. [10]Greet Apelles, who is approved in Christ. Greet
those who belong to the family of Aristobulus. [11]Greet my
kinsman Herodion. Greet those in the Lord who belong to
the family of Narcissus. [12]Greet those workers in the Lord,
Tryphaena and Tryphosa. Greet the beloved Persis, who has
worked hard in the Lord. [13]Greet Rufus, chosen in the Lord;
also his mother, who has been a mother to me as well. [14]Greet
Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermes, Patrobas, Hermas, and the
brothers who are with them. [15]Greet Philologus, Julia, Nereus

and his sister, and Olympas, and all the saints who are with
them. [16]Greet one another with a holy kiss. All the churches
of Christ greet you.

[17]I appeal to you, brothers, to watch out for those who
cause divisions and create obstacles contrary to the doctrine
that you have been taught; avoid them. [18]For such persons
do not serve our Lord Christ, but their own appetites, and by
smooth talk and flattery they deceive the hearts of the naive.
[19]For your obedience is known to all, so that I rejoice over you,
but I want you to be wise as to what is good and innocent as
to what is evil. [20]The God of peace will soon crush Satan under
your feet. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

[21]Timothy, my fellow worker, greets you; so do Lucius and
Jason and Sosipater, my kinsmen.

[22]I Tertius, who wrote this letter, greet you in the Lord.

[23]Gaius, who is host to me and to the whole church, greets
you. Erastus, the city treasurer, and our brother Quartus,
greet you.

[25]Now to him who is able to strengthen you according to
my gospel and the preaching of Jesus Christ, according to the
revelation of the mystery that was kept secret for long ages
[26]but has now been disclosed and through the prophetic writ-
ings has been made known to all nations, according to the
command of the eternal God, to bring about the obedience of
faith—[27]to the only wise God be glory forevermore through
Jesus Christ! Amen.